



What Everyone Knows

Ten things (which may not even be true) everyone knows about the Western Reaches.

1. The Reaches are ancient.

They've been here since the sun first rose over the western shore. Some say the land came up out of the sea, or the gods sculpted it all out of clay, or the dwarves hammered it together on anvils. Nobody really knows. But there's plenty of old stuff all around that must have been built ages ago.

2. There are faraway lands.

They say the Reaches stretch all the way up to a frozen land of endless night, and all the way down to deserts so hot they'll cook you alive. There's even a big city on the coast. City of Masks, they call it. Most people don't travel too far, though. Too risky.

3. It's dangerous out there.

Nobody's going to come riding to your rescue! These are lawless lands full of bandits and thieves. Wild beasts and trolls. Evil spirits. You better not go alone.

4. The world ends at the Last Sea. There's nothing else west of the coast. Just the Last Sea rolling on and on into mist.

Some say if you keep going, you'll eventually arrive at the shores of the gods' realm and you can ask them for one thing. But you'd never make it back from there anyhow.

5. No king has ever ruled all the Reaches.

Sure, some have tried. But the Reaches have no king, not now, not ever. There was a queen long ago who almost conquered it all from top to bottom, but her heart was dark and the gods cast her down. Every child knows the song: *Rise and fight, sun from night, dark queen tumbles out of sight.*

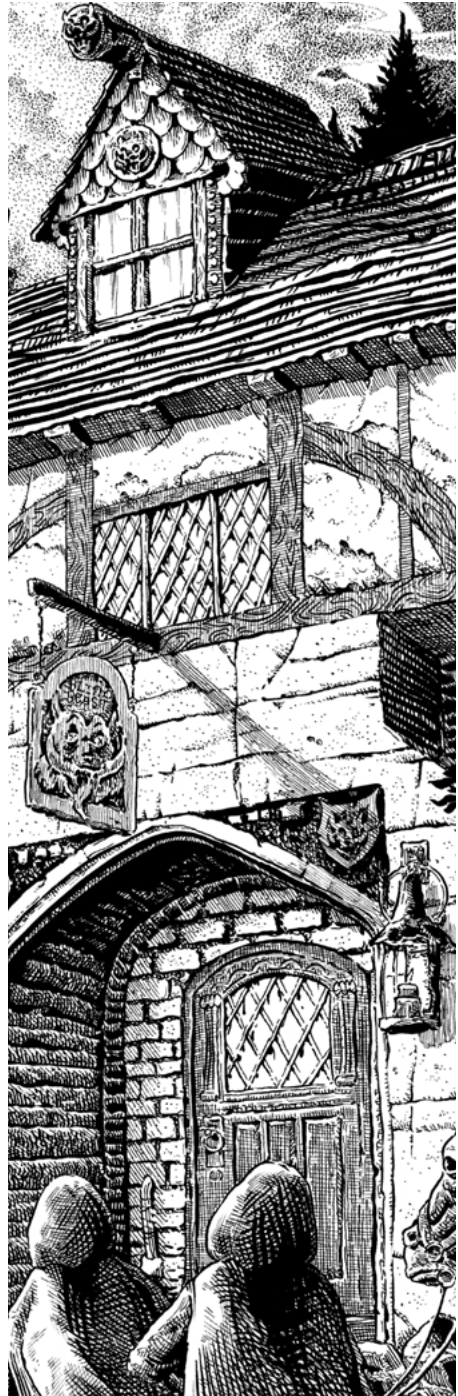
6. The gods are distant. The gods don't walk among us anymore. And they don't intervene. There are a few rare folks like priests who can channel their power. That's how we know they're still watching over us, for good or for ill.

7. Ancient spirits and beings dwell here. There's all kinds of strange demons and ghosts lurking around in the wilds. You've heard of the Willowman who comes to scare children who don't listen. He's real! And there are other things like him.

8. Magic is terribly dangerous. Most folks don't trust a wizard, I'll tell you that. Only a madman lets a wizard cast a spell in his house. You'll get yourself blown up that way. Even touching a magic sword has half a chance of cursing you blind!

9. Non-humans aren't very common. Elves, dwarves, you don't often see them. We do get a traveler from time to time, and the kids always want to ask them a barrel of questions.

10. Most of the Reaches are unexplored. You'll hear a couple of tall tales from sailors, but most folks haven't seen much farther than the ends of their own noses. Hard to believe half the stuff those sailors say, anyway. None of them have even been to the south. Can't sail a boat over the desert, can you?



Life in the Reaches

ANCESTRIES

Humans are by far the most common ancestry in the Western Reaches, but there are a wide scattering of other peoples and civilizations.

Dwarves, elves, and halflings are uncommon. Half-orcs, half-elves, goblins, and kobolds are rare.

Population. Optionally, players can roll on the below chart for their characters' ancestries if they want the party to align with the average population percentages in the Reaches.

ANCESTRY	
d100	Ancestry
01-54	Human
55-64	Elf
65-74	Dwarf
75-84	Halfling
85-89	Goblin
90-94	Half-elf
95-99	Half-orc
00	Kobold

POINTS OF LIGHT

The Western Reaches is a "points of light" setting where there are small pockets of fragile civilization, usually in the form of self-governed towns and city-states. Most places outside these areas are dangerous and lawless.

MIGHT MAKES RIGHT

When there is no overall rule of law, street justice prevails. Bandits, monsters, thieves, and worse roam the wilds of the Western Reaches, often acting with impunity against the weak.

Adventurers will have to defend themselves, make allies, and act wisely if they hope to survive outside the safety of civilization.

The wilds will eventually wear down even the toughest adventurers. Characters will need to retreat back to town on a regular basis to rest, restock, and recount their exploits in a carousing celebration!

CIVILIZATIONS

Most people who dwell in the Western Reaches have at least heard of the other centers of power in the region and know a few facts about them.

City of Masks. The Duke reigns over this romantic city of high culture, art, and danger. It's the biggest city-state in all the Western Reaches.

Alkesh. A princess called the Shar rules Alkesh. The city is a mysterious, bright oasis in the desert where you can buy anything for the right price.

Stonehall. A dwarf king as old as three men presides over a vast hall under the mountains. The dwarves of Stonehall are the best crafters in all the land.

Kyzian Steppes. Wild tribes of horseback riders roam across the plains like a moving army. Their queen is a feared warrior.

Lydonia. An aloof elf king rules over a shining citadel deep in the forest. His rangers and knights watch from behind every tree and blade of grass.

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

Most people in the Western Reaches come from humble means and get by working in a trade or craft.

If they live in a city-state or its nearby lands, they pledge loyalty to its overlord and serve as vassals in exchange for the overlord's protection.

In most parts of the reaches, there is no overlord. Many towns and villages have no other authority but their own and must protect themselves from outside dangers.

There is no universal set of laws, governance, or culture across the Western Reaches.

A knight from the Duchy of Montmar would not be recognized or treated as a noble by the lawless bandit lords who roam the Djurum Desert.

A visitor in the City of Masks might unknowingly break one of the Duke's laws. In Alkesh, the very same "crime" might be perfectly legal, or perhaps it is punished even more harshly.

Half-Elf

HALF-ELF

Lithe, long-lived humans with subtle elven features. Their boldness is tempered by insight.

You know the Common and Elvish languages, plus one additional common language.

Adaptable. Roll your talent rolls twice and choose which result to keep.



POPULATION

Half-elves are rarely seen. They make up 5% of the population.

ORIGINS

Half-elves typically hail from the Kyzian Steppes or the Djurum Desert where their parents have the greatest crossover in territory. They are beloved by both peoples and seen as a symbol of alliance. Half-elves often become legendary horse riders, archers, and leaders.

NAMES		
d10	Part 1	Part 2
1	Me-	-garrin
2	Ira-	-sandiel
3	Im-	-rak
4	Hu-	-teril
5	Gal-	-rynn
6	Tova-	-barik
7	Syr-	-lena
8	Or-	-seniel
9	Lir-	-dess
10	Cal-	-dorin

HALF-ELF TRINKET

d100	Details	d100	Details
1-2	Braided horsehair lock	51-52	Book of plant drawings
3-4	Silver leaf brooch	53-54	Carved bone fishhook
5-6	Red saddle blanket	55-56	Circlet of deer antlers
7-8	Bowstring bracelet	57-58	Shard of a silvery mirror
9-10	Carved quartz ring	59-60	Bag of glass marbles
11-12	Father's sword belt	61-62	A single old playing card
13-14	Hay-stuffed luck doll	63-64	Copper disc necklace
15-16	Arrowhead necklace	65-66	Filigreed hair pin
17-18	Lucky horseshoe	67-68	Green silk handkerchief
19-20	Pressed prairie flower	69-70	Silver camel hair hat
21-22	Bottle of red sand	71-72	Vial of perfumed oil
21-24	Horse bone dice	73-74	Leather hat with feather
25-26	Wide straw hat	75-76	Tiny locket housing a leaf
27-28	Wood gnome figurine	77-78	Silver spinning top
29-30	White silk headband	79-80	Miniature wind chime
31-32	Embroidered overcoat	81-82	Bundle of scented twigs
33-34	Frayed horsehair brush	83-84	Finely tailored dress robe
35-36	Copper arm cuff	85-86	Wax-sealed note
37-38	Chain of horse bells	87-88	Bundle of red feathers
39-40	Tassled arrow quiver	89-90	Blue camel blanket
41-42	Skin of wheat beer	91-92	Hawk hood and glove
43-44	Ball of knotted string	93-94	Pot of black eye coal
45-46	Bent silver nail	95-96	Silver pan pipes
47-48	Soft leather slippers	97-98	Moonstone ring
49-50	Letter from mother	99-00	Heirloom family weapon

PCs may start with one trinket; it is free to carry.

Kyzian Archer

Swift horse riders who race across the Steppes like wolf packs. They are trained in the deadly Kyzian archery style.

Weapons: Dagger, longbow, shortbow, sling, scimitar

Armor: Leather armor

Hit Points: 1d6 per level

Hawk Eye. Three times per day, add 1 + half your level (round down) to your next ranged attack and its damage roll.

Kyzian Quiver. One of your arrow quivers can hold up to 80 arrows while only occupying one gear slot.

Mount. You have a warhorse with a lovely demeanor (see pg. 148). It comes when you call. You can only have one such mount at a time.

Your mount has additional levels equal to half your level (round down).

While riding your mount in combat, you are not slowed by difficult terrain.

If you lose your mount, you can use your downtime to acquire and train another warhorse. Pass a DC 15 CHA check for the new warhorse to become your mount. Lower the DC by one step with each attempt.



KYZIAN ARCHER TALENTS

2d6	Effect
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2	The damage of one weapon type you wield becomes a d10
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3-6	+1 to ranged attacks and damage
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7-9	+2 to Strength, Dexterity, or Constitution stat
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10-11	Gain an additional use of Hawk Eye per day
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12	Choose a talent or +2 points to distribute to stats
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Roustabout Class

Average laggards of no particular talent. They wield weapons and magic with the elegance of a hog-tied kobold. But if their back is against a wall, a glint of bravery may, on rare occasions, rise to the surface.

Weapons: Club, dagger, hammer (as club), staff

Armor: Leather armor

Hit Points: 1d4 per level

Knowaguy. You have advantage on checks related to interacting with commoners and sourcing favors.

Lucksmith. Whenever another player uses your luck token, they have advantage on the new roll.

Surprising Guts. When you are reduced to half your HP or lower, you have advantage on your next roll.

ROUSTABOUT TALENTS

2d6 Effect

2	+1 to any stat and roll another talent
3-6	Gain the ability to wield a new weapon or armor
7-9	+1 to any two stats (they can't be the same)
10-11	Roll an extra hit points die this level
12	Learn any spell of a tier equal to half your level rounded down (min. 1). Cast it using that class's spellcasting stat

"I knew I should have stayed home today!"
-Arnold, halfling roustabout



Warlock Class

Howling warriors with sharpened teeth, wild-eyed doomspeakers preaching of The Dissolution, and cloaked lore-hunters bearing the hidden Mark of Shune.

Weapons: Club, crossbow, dagger, mace, longsword

Armor: Leather armor, chainmail, and shields

Hit Points: 1d6 per level

Languages. You know either Celestial, Diabolic, Draconic, Primordial, or Sylvan.

Patron. Choose a patron to serve (see pg. 70). Your patron is the source of your supernatural gifts.

Your patron can choose to grant or withhold its gifts at any time. You can gain new Patron Boons/ talents (or lose them) as a result.

Patron Boon. At 1st level, you gain a random Patron Boon talent (see pg. 72) based on your chosen patron.

Whenever you gain a new talent roll, you may choose to roll on your Patron Boon table rather than the Warlock Talents table.



WARLOCK TALENTS

2d6	Effect
2	Roll a Patron Boon from any patron; an unexplained gift
3-6	Add +1 point to two stats (they must be different)
7-9	+1 to melee or ranged attacks
10-11	Roll two Patron Boons and choose one to keep
12	Choose a talent or +2 points to distribute to stats

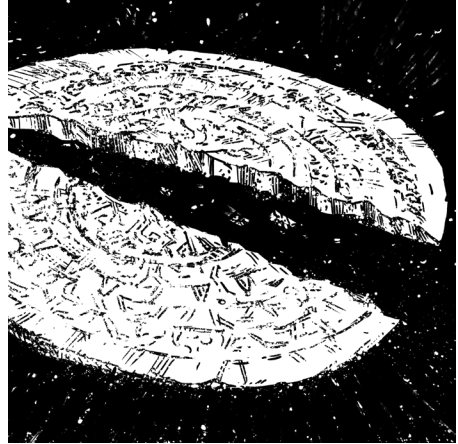


The Lost

CHAOTIC

The Lost are chaotic gods.

They were once two of The Nine primary gods in the Reaches. But the other gods cast them down for unspeakable crimes. Their names are lost, expunged, forgotten, yet there are those who seek to remember.



TENETS

1. Seek The Lost. They are out there, whispering and waiting. They want to be found. They must be found.
2. Free The Lost. They are held imprisoned, and it can not be. They want to be freed. They must be freed.
3. Destroy those who cast out The Lost. They have sown their own fates. The Lost want vengeance. It must be reaped.

IN THE REACHES

Worshipping The Lost is a form of blasphemy. Most people in the Reaches consider it bad luck to even speak about The Lost, let alone revere them. Whatever they did to be cast down by the other gods must have been unforgivable.

Yet cultists gather in every dark corner of the Reaches, and the zealots who pledge their souls to The Lost are some of the most dangerous ones indeed.

New Options

The following options are extra details you can add to enhance your character's motivations and connections in the Reaches.

BACKGROUNDS

This section provides a list of d100 backgrounds drawn from all around the Western Reaches.

Each section is sub-divided by major region if you prefer to roll within a certain area (each section has d12 entries).

SECRETS

This section is a list of d100 secrets players can use to give their character an interesting plot thread to follow.

It's usually best practice to share the secret with the Game Master so it can be incorporated into the campaign world.

Some players may prefer to keep their character's secret hidden from the other players until it becomes relevant.

FACTIONS

Pages ## - ## of this chapter detail four factions the PCs can join (a PC can only be a member of one faction a time).

Factions help unite characters around a common cause. Some player groups choose to all be part of the same faction.

If a character in the party dies, their successor might also be from the same faction so that player can keep continuity in goals and hanging threads.

The Bards. An order of noble heroes intent on doing good.

The Jeweled Eye. A secretive faction of ambitious and self-interested treasure hunters.

The Torchbearers. A broad collective of adventurers looking for glory and new exploits.

Wolves of Lydonia. A group of protectors trying to keep the wilds from harming civilization.

The Bards

The Bards is a lawful order that fights for knowledge and justice.

Their **symbol** is a gold pendant of a nine-pointed star, often referred to as The Duke's Rose.

The faction is led by the honorable and wise Master Poet Yeothin, chancellor of the Bardic College in the City of Masks.



MISSION

To preserve important knowledge and prevent the rise of evil in the Western Reaches.

BYLAWS

1. Do not allow evil to stand uncontested.
2. Bring light and hope to the weak and defenseless.
3. Seek artifacts, knowledge, and experience so it may be kept safe in your hands.

IN THE REACHES

The Bards operate out of the City of Masks, but they travel far around the Reaches in small groups. People greet bards with joy and, often, requests for help.

Typical members include bards, fighters, lawful priests, and those with strong moral fiber.

Members in good standing learn a mix of rumors about **evil plots**, **magic items**, and **people who need help**.

The Jeweled Eye

The Jeweled Eye is a neutral faction that places the pursuit of knowledge and power above all.

Their **symbol** is a ring with a gem carved like a cat's eye.

The order's secretive leader is Afarim Zarad, a wealthy and reclusive sorcerer who lives in The Spires district of Alkesh.



MISSION

To accumulate magical artifacts, wealth, and secrets for the individual members' benefit.

BYLAWS

1. Pursue that which you seek with all your skill and effort.
2. Gather power to yourself. Use it to shape the world.
3. Respect the right of first claim of fellow Jeweled Eyes members. Ignore it for all others.

IN THE REACHES

The Jeweled Eye is secretive and does not make its presence widely known, though its members conduct clandestine meetings in all major cities.

Typical members include wizards, thieves, chaotic priests, and those with deep personal ambitions.

Members in good standing learn an abundance of quality rumors about **magical treasures**.

The Torchbearers

The Torchbearers is a neutral faction that believes in living a glorious life full of adventure.

Their **symbol** is a dagger with a pommel shaped as a flame.

They do not have a centralized leader, but members induct each other and enforce the bylaws by local majority vote.



MISSION

To delve into forgotten places, loot them, and come back with amazing stories to tell.

BYLAWS

1. Share knowledge, rumors, strategies, and ideas. The glory of one is the glory of all.
2. Compensate Torchbearers who help you. Share the spoils.
3. Do what you must, but do not harm fellow Torchbearers.

IN THE REACHES

The Torchbearers can be found all around the Reaches. They have a presence in all major cities and choose a favorite tavern to turn into their regular meeting grounds.

Typical members include those of all backgrounds and skill sets who seek adventure and glory.

Members in good standing learn a blend of rumors about **adventuring sites** and **treasures**.

MEMBERSHIP BENEFITS

PC Level Benefits While In Good Standing

1-2	Once per level, you may roll on the treasure table matching your level and immediately gain the item
3-4	Gain 1 XP each time you publicly one-up a rival adventuring party (limit once per encounter with them)
5-6	Once per level, maximize your death timer roll
7-8	Gain 1 XP each time you expend a luck token
9-10	A noble who is a fan of your exploits grants you a luxurious manor home in any region you wish; guild members who rest here gain +5 temporary HP (max 5)

CITY-STATE PRESENCE

City-State	Details
City of Masks	Meetings at the Pale Toad tavern in Gedgarrin district, limited access to the private library in Gedgarrin university, forays into Lowland Moor
Alkesh	Lively gatherings at The Jewel of Borak tavern in the Forgotten Quarter, organized delves into the ancient tunnels beneath the city
Stonehall	Welcome at the Braided Beard tavern in The Clanks district where dwarf prospectors contract Torchbearers to clear out dangerous mines and investigate weird findings
Kyzian Tribes	Tenuous allowances by Kyzian Princes to explore certain areas, no organized presence in the region but occasional shared camps near delve sites
Lydonia	Jovial meetings at the Court of Mab tavern in the Cerulean Quarter, frequent partnerships with the Wolves of Lydonia that are mutually beneficial